

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1108

By Clemmons

A RESOLUTION to honor Hillsboro High School, winner of the MNPS High School Battle of the Books.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly recognize those industrious, talented students of Tennessee who bring pride and honor to our State; and

WHEREAS, the students of Hillsboro High School recently proved victorious during the Metro Nashville Public School's (MNPS) High School Battle of the Books, besting thirteen other district schools in a show of teamwork and dedication; and

WHEREAS, the MNPS High School Battle of the Books is an annual, book-centered trivia competition sponsored by the Library Services Department; begun in 2012, the competition promotes literacy, teamwork, and deeper engagement with school library resources; and

WHEREAS, a committee of school and public librarians select twelve books for the competition each year; the books must be high-quality, recently published works that represent a variety of fiction and nonfiction genres; and

WHEREAS, one of the books selected is by a local author, who is invited to speak to students at the event, and students receive a signed copy of the book, courtesy of the Parnassus Foundation; and

WHEREAS, the event is planned by Dr. Alyssa Littrell from MNPS Library Services with the support of numerous volunteers from MNPS and the Nashville Public Library; participation in the Battle of the Books is an extracurricular activity that challenges students to read beyond their assigned classroom texts; and

WHEREAS, high school librarians promote the opportunity to all students and select and coach a team; each team consists of five students who read a shared list of twelve young adult

fiction and nonfiction titles, log many hours of practice, and compete against other schools in the district; and

WHEREAS, the competition includes three preliminary rounds, after which the four highest scoring teams advance to the semifinal round; the top two teams then move on to the final round, where one team is awarded the first-place title; and

WHEREAS, in each round, teams answer twenty questions centered on trivia from the twelve titles on the Battle of the Books reading list; and

WHEREAS, this year's High School Battle of the Books was held on February 18, 2026, at the Martin Professional Development Center in Nashville; fourteen high school teams participated in the highly competitive event, and after answering one hundred questions about the twelve titles, Hillsboro High School took home the first-place trophy; and

WHEREAS, in addition to Hillsboro High School, the participating schools and their librarian coaches were Antioch High School, Lauren Williams; East Nashville High School, Tyler Sainato; Glenclyff High School, Julie Halkiades; Hume-Fogg High School, Amanda Smithfield; Hunters Lane High School, Amy Carlson; James Lawson High School, Natalia Fallon; John Overton High School, Krista Winningham; Maplewood High School, Karen Yarbrough; Martin Luther King Jr. School, Cami Townsel; McGavock High School, Kim Norment; Nashville School of the Arts, Hope Hall; Stratford High School, Diane Chen; and Whites Creek High School, Kearea Brady; and

WHEREAS, the students at Hillsboro High School were coached by school librarian Joyce Claassen, whose wisdom and encouragement proved vital to the team's success; and

WHEREAS, the display of aptitude and ambition by the students at Hillsboro High School surely bodes well for their future success, and their dedication to excellence is clearly deserving of our respect, admiration, and commendation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we commend and congratulate Hillsboro High School, winner of the MNPS High School Battle of the Books, extending our best wishes for much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.